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ELECTION 2027 CHICAGO MAYOR

Johnson eyes four more years

Progressive incumbent turns in 33K signatures, skipping lottery for the final spot on the ballot

By Alice Yin and Jake Sheridan
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Mayor Brandon Johnson submitted his election nominating petitions Friday, ceding the lottery for the last spot on the 2027 ballot to challengers in a surprise move he said proves how confident he is.

Lugging in about 33,000 signatures on a blue trolley, the mayor arrived at the Chicago Board of Elections Loop Supersite lobby just before 1 p.m. with his 18-inch high stack of petitions, with one volunteer adding nine sheets at the last minute.

Johnson stopped before a group of photographers and held up four fingers.

"Four more years," he said, a slogan that about a dozen supporters repeated once he marched out of the elevators upstairs.

Johnson skipped the first day to turn in petition signatures Monday, meaning five of his rivals instead earned a draw in the lottery to be the first name to appear on the crowded mayoral election ballot: Businessman Willie Wilson, lobbyist John Kelly, U.S. Rep. Mike Quigley, Chicago Housing Authority Commissioner Matt Brewer and Illinois Secretary of State Alexi

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Chicago Board of Elections senior clerk Ralph Baker, left, helps Mayor Brandon Johnson file his election nominating petitions on Friday at the Loop Supersite. **TERRENCE ANTONIO JAMES/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

"In the history of the world, there has never been anyone like you. ... Go forth with the confidence of this remarkable education you have."

FORMER HOUSE SPEAKER NANCY PELOSI, during her commencement address



UNLOCKING POSSIBILITIES

18 incarcerated women earn bachelor's degrees from Northwestern University

By Kate Perez | CHICAGO TRIBUNE

KEWANEE — The educators made their way into the white outdoor tent first, decked out in master's regalia that provided a bit of warmth on the nippy October morning and accessorized with wide smiles. In purple robes and tassels displaying Northwestern University's seal embossed on a metal medallion, 18 women followed, the sound of "Pomp and Circumstance" carrying across the yard of Kewanee Life Skills Re-Entry Center.

One by one, the women were cheered into the tent by professors, family and friends, each breaking rank briefly to embrace those lining the aisles who showed up on a Friday morning this month to the prison in the small northwestern Illinois city of Kewanee to see their loved ones graduate from the Northwestern Prison Education Program.

Since 2018, NU's prison program has offered incarcerated people in Illinois who have earned a high school diploma or passed the GED a chance to learn from the school, with four educational programs available at facilities throughout the state ranging from four- to six-week college-readiness courses to a bachelor's degree. While the program has graduated two cohorts of incarcerated men in recent years, this ceremony marked the first time incarcerated women students in the U.S. earned a bachelor's degree from a top 10 university.

That first cohort of incarcerated women graduates traveled

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Joyce McGee cheers for professor Jennifer Lackey, director of the Northwestern Prison Education Program, during a graduation ceremony at Kewanee Life Skills Re-Entry Center on Oct. 16 in Kewanee. **STACEY WESCOTT/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Russian diesel tanker heading to US in Trump-Putin deal

ASSOCIATED PRESS

A first tanker carrying Russian diesel to the United States under a new import agreement has set sail, the Kremlin said Friday, two weeks after President Donald Trump said he struck a deal with President Vladimir Putin despite Moscow's invasion of Ukraine.

"The first oil tanker has sailed off to customers, and regular supplies will continue," Kremlin spokesperson Dmitry Peskov said without elaborating.

Russian Deputy Prime Minister Alexander Novak said earlier this week that the first shipment would amount to 40,000 tons of diesel, according to Russia's Interfax news agency. That's around 300,000 barrels, or about 7% of the roughly 4 million barrels of diesel the U.S. economy consumes in a single day.

The diesel deal was seen as an attempt by Trump to address high fuel prices ahead of the Nov. 3 midterm elections.

It caused alarm and dismay in Ukraine, which has pleaded with foreign countries to tighten sanctions on Moscow and deny it revenue for the invasion launched in

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Proposals for census alarming advocates

White House moves to cut questions on race, sex orientation

By Robert McCoppin
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

A Trump administration proposal to eliminate questions about race, ethnicity and sexual orientation from the U.S. census could hurt efforts to address inequities in Chicago and across the nation, health and civil rights advocates warn.

The proposal is part of the administration's broader effort to eliminate diversity, equity and inclusion programs. The U.S. Census Bureau states in the proposal that the process "should be colorblind and not be distorted in any way by questions about immaterial personal characteristics."

Race has been a census category since the census started in 1790, and racial and ethnicity information has been used for decades as the basis for enforcing voting rights, tracking disparities and monitoring preferences for minorities and women.

Minority advocates say the change would be highly significant, ending a wide variety of datasets used to counter inequalities in healthcare, housing and education.

Race is fundamental to the ways in which societies and markets organize people, according to research by Lez Trujillo Torres, assistant professor of marketing at the University of Illinois Chicago, who studies how race plays a role in the marketplace.

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INSIDE

Suspect acquitted in trans woman's death

A jury on Friday found a Chicago man not guilty of luring a transgender woman into an alley and killing her in order to conceal his involvement with her. The acquittal came more than eight years after the slaying of Dejanay Stanton, whose death spurred advocates to call for better protections for the transgender community. **Chicagoland, Page A3**

KMET OUT FOR THE SEASON: The Bears delivered a complete team win over Patriots, but it came with a price for their veteran tight end. **Sports**

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TODAY	SUN.	MON.
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